venture enterprises like Anjin Investments – involved with the military in the Marange diamond fields – and Sino-Zimbabwe Holdings, which previously had a concession in Marange as well. According to a recent report by Global Witness, Anjin enjoys the most lucrative diamond concessions. One gift, in exchange, was US$98 million for the construction of the army's National Defence College. Sino-Zimbabwe is now conducting chrome mining along the Great Dyke belt.

Russia

There has been a steady increase of Russian companies operating in Zimbabwe's mining sector in the past decade. The frozen relations between Zimbabwe and the West since the early 2000s gave Russia and her BRICS allies the opportunity to penetrate Zimbabwe's mining sector with ease. Although Zimbabwe derives no tangible economic benefits from its strong ties with Moscow, political and military ties between the two countries continue to grow strong.

As a symbol of Russia's growing influence in Zimbabwe, in September 2014 President Putin dispatched a high-powered delegation led by Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov as well as the Industry Minister Denis Manturov to negotiate several deals, especially in the mining sector with Zimbabwe. The highlight of the tour was the signing of a US$4.8 billion platinum deal, with Russia promising to provide the investment funds. Russian firms Rostec and Vnesheconom Bank are part of a clandestine consortium that involves Russia's defence industries. Rostec is Russia's biggest arms manufacturer, comprising 663 entities that form 13 companies, of which eight operate in the military-industrial complex while Vnesheconom Bank is tasked with financing the deal.

The deal, which stands out as the largest single foreign investment Zimbabwe has had in over a decade, followed a visit to Russia by Zimbabwe's Finance and Economic Development Minister Patrick Chinamasa and Mines and Mining Development Minister Walter Chidhakwa in July 2014. The platinum deal was hailed by both Mugabe and the visiting Russian ministers as a key driver in Zimbabwe's economic recovery. However, it turned out the deal is nothing more than a military relationship whose benefits will entirely accrue to the army. The Zimbabwean government is represented in the deal by Pen East Mining Company, believed to be a subsidiary of Zimbabwe Defence Industries, which falls under the Ministry of Defence. The Ministry of Mines appears to have little control over the deal. Given that Rostec is into arms manufacturing and given the EU arms ban on Zimbabwe, it is apparent that the Darwendale platinum deal is a barter trade to enable the Zimbabwe National Army to acquire military hardware in exchange for platinum.